FOR SMALL & MEDIUM-SIZED BUSINESS OWNERS

14 internal tools worth considering before your next software renewal

> The top 14 from a list of 62

THE SHIFT

Some companies are replacing paid software with custom tools.

$40K → ~$1,200

Atonom was paying about $40K a year for its CRM (25–30 users). Its custom replacement runs about $1,200 a year.

~$35K a year

Saved by O3 World after replacing a resource planning platform with a custom app.

Results as reported in Lovable customer stories.
Savings depend on your setup, so run the numbers first.

#1 Finance Dashboard

Cash runway, a 13-week cash forecast, budget vs. actual, and who owes you, in one view. Upload exports from your finance tools to see variance by line, instead of pulling month-end numbers from several spreadsheets or rebuilding the same budget report every month.

#2 Overdue Invoice Tracker

Every unpaid invoice sorted by days overdue, with optional reminder drafts, so you’re not chasing payments from memory.

#3 Expense Claims & Approvals

Employees snap a receipt on their phone to claim a reimbursement, with policy checks, two-step sign-off, and a full audit trail. Instead of approvals buried in email, paper receipts at month-end, or per-user expense app fees.

#4 Sales Pipeline CRM

Drag-and-drop deals with forecasting, built around how you sell, instead of per-seat pricing for features outside your process.

#5 Quote Generator

Branded, line-item proposals sent through a secure client link. An alternative to document templates and back-and-forth, or a monthly proposal software subscription.

#6 Approval Tracker

One request form for time off, purchases, and access, with a manager review queue. No more “Did you see my email?”

#7 Branded Client Portal

Projects, files, and invoices behind one login, with your logo on it. Instead of client files in several places, or a per-user portal subscription.

#8 Inventory Tracker

Stock levels in one place, with low-stock flags and trend tracking. An alternative to manual counts and estimates, or a monthly inventory app subscription.

#9 License & Credential Tracker

Staff licenses and certifications in one place, with expiration reminders, so a lapsed license is less likely to surprise you. An alternative to a paid compliance tracking subscription.

#10 Commission Calculator

Commissions calculated from your tiered rates and logged deals, with payout reports. Fewer commission spreadsheets and payout questions.

#11 Hiring Pipeline Tracker

One shared pipeline for candidates and open roles, with hiring stages and funnel reports. An alternative to candidates tracked across inboxes and spreadsheets, or per-seat recruiting software.

#12 Employee Onboarding Portal

A day-one checklist portal for new hires, with tasks, documents, and progress in one place. An alternative to static onboarding docs and checklists.

#13 Vendor Invoice Capture

Reads vendor bills from a shared inbox, checks them against the purchase order, and drafts the bill for approval. Instead of keying in vendor bills by hand, or a paid AP automation subscription.

#14 Timesheet App with Supervisor Review

Staff log hours on their phone, a supervisor approves them, and approved hours flow to payroll. An alternative to paper or spreadsheet timesheets, or a per-user time tracking subscription.

That’s 14 of 62.

Want the full list?
Send me a message here on LinkedIn, and I’ll share it.

Have one or two in mind? I can help with the numbers, the build, the rollout, or just the parts you need.

HOW I BUILD THESE

1. Scope it with you.
2. Prototype on a short turnaround.
3. Test and refine it.
4. Walk you through it.

Dominic Andreas, CPA | Fractional AI Lead
hello.ai.audit@gmail.com
aiauditdesk.github.io